STRIDE IISP 4.0

Acceptable Use Policy

Version [1.1]

Purpose:

The purpose of this Acceptable Use Policy (AUP) is to define the acceptable and responsible use of Stride's information systems, networks, and resources. This policy aims to protect the integrity, confidentiality, and availability of company data while ensuring compliance with applicable laws, regulations, and organizational security standards.

Scope and Applicability

These policies and standards apply to all Stride-owned technology and business operations.

All workforce members and their respective facilities supporting Stride business operations, technology, or both, wherever Stride data is stored or processed, including any third party contracted by Stride to handle, process, transmit, store, or dispose of Stride data are subject to the requirements of this document.

All data, systems, activities, and assets owned, leased, controlled, or used by Stride, its affiliates, subsidiaries, agents, contractors, or other business partners acting on behalf of Stride fall within the scope of the requirements outlined in this document.

The requirements outlined in this document apply where technically feasible and commercially reasonable, as determined by executive management. Any exceptions to these standards must be requested, using the approved workflow, and remain documented until compliance has been achieved. Exceptions are only granted temporarily for periods of up to one calendar year.

Definitions

All definitions are located within Stride - ISP 1.2 – IT Policy Definitions.

Any inquiries regarding terminology or clarity may be directed to Stride's Information Security Team for assistance.

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Document Control

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This document will be reviewed at least annually and reissued when revisions are necessary. Any changes introduced in the most recent version are itemized below. Obsolete copies should be destroyed or archived upon the release of the newest version.

Implementation and Compliance

All business units are required to comply with any changes applied to the most recent version of this publication within 90 days from the date of publication.

Change History

Version	Date of Change	Summary of Change(s)
1.0	10/06/2022	Initial Release
1.1	02/27/2025	Review and Update. Added privacy statement and clarification throughout.
1.1	05/19/2025	Approved by VP Information Security
1.1	05/29/2025	Approved by PMC
1.1	06/25/2025	Approved by Legal
1.1	09/23/2025	Approved by LCEC
1.1	09/24/2025	Published

Privacy Statement

Stride's IT resources, including communication systems, computers, and electronic devices, are strictly for business use. Workforce members should not expect privacy when using Stride-issued equipment, as communications may be monitored, accessed, or disclosed. Employees working with public education institutions may have their communications subject to public records requests.

Stride reserves the right to restrict IT resource usage, block non-business websites, and limit personal device connections. All communications must follow business standards and may be reviewed for legal or regulatory purposes. Unauthorized access to another employee's communications is prohibited. Prior authorization is required to access Stride's IT resources via personal devices.

By using Stride's IT systems, workforce members agree to these terms.

User Responsibility for IT Equipment

Stride, Inc., and its affiliates (collectively referred to as "Stride") provide IT equipment, including computers, printers, accessories, cellular phones, and personal digital assistants, to workforce members and contractors (hereinafter referred to as "Users"). This equipment remains the property of Stride and must be used responsibly and returned immediately upon request or separation from the organization.

Users must exercise professional judgment and common sense when handling Stride's IT resources. Misuse may result in financial liability for replacement costs, disciplinary action, or the revocation of future IT privileges.

Equipment Ownership & Return

- All IT equipment issued to Users is the property of Stride and must be returned immediately upon request or upon an employee's separation from the organization.
- Users may be held financially responsible for the replacement value of any assigned equipment if it is not returned to Stride.
- Users who repeatedly lose or damage IT equipment may be denied future IT device issuance at the discretion of the organization.

Acceptable Use

All uses of information and information technology resources must comply with organizational policies, standards, procedures, and guidelines, as well as any applicable license agreements and laws, including Federal, State, local, and intellectual property laws.

Consistent with the foregoing, the acceptable use of information and IT resources encompasses the following duties:

- Understanding the baseline information security controls necessary to protect the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of information.
- Protecting organizational information and resources from unauthorized use or disclosure.
- Protecting personal, private, sensitive, or confidential information from unauthorized use or disclosure.
- Observing authorized levels of access and utilizing only approved IT technology devices or services.
- Immediately report any suspected security incidents, vulnerabilities, or weaknesses to the appropriate manager and the Information Security Team at cyber@k12.com to ensure timely assessment and response.

Unacceptable Use

This list provides a framework for prohibited activities related to organizational IT resources. Users may be granted exemptions for specific job-related responsibilities with prior approval from management and Information Security (e.g., storing objectionable material in the context of a disciplinary matter).

Prohibited Activities:

- Unauthorized use or disclosure of personal, sensitive, or confidential information.
- Unauthorized access or sharing of organizational data and resources.
- Dissemination of inappropriate content, including material that is threatening, obscene, harassing, pornographic, defamatory, discriminatory, inflammatory, illegal, or intentionally misleading.
- Misrepresentation of the organization in any capacity outside officially authorized responsibilities.
- Connecting unapproved devices to the organization's network or IT systems.
- Linking organizational IT resources to unauthorized or external networks.
- Simultaneous wired and wireless network connections within the organization.

- Installation or use of unapproved software without security, legal, or IT review per organizational policies.
- Using commercial email services (e.g., Gmail, Hotmail, Yahoo) without prior management approval and formal Information Security review and risk assessment, including forwarding organizational data to these platforms.
- Installation or use of artificial intelligence platforms (e.g., ChatGPT, Perplexity, Stable Diffusion) without prior security, legal, or IT review per organizational policies. Unauthorized AI tools pose potential risks related to data privacy, security vulnerabilities, and unintended disclosure of proprietary or sensitive information.
- Using IT resources for unauthorized solicitations, including religious, political, or nonprofit promotions.
- Granting unauthorized third-party access to organizational IT resources.
- Engaging in commercial or personal for-profit activities using organizational IT resources.
- Distributing chain letters, fraudulent mass mailings, spam, or other unwanted emails.
- Tampering with, disabling, or circumventing security controls.

Use of the Internet

Workforce members must ensure that internet usage is effective, ethical, and lawful. Instant messaging and software may be used for official Stride business or to seek technical or analytical advice. Databases may be accessed as needed to fulfill job responsibilities, and email should be used for professional communications.

Users must respect Stride's system capacity and refrain from excessive internet use that could disrupt operations or hinder other users while onsite. The suitability of any usage will be evaluated based on the specific circumstances.

Occasional and Limited Personal Use

Employees may use IT resources for personal purposes on a limited, incidental, and necessary basis, provided that such use:

- Adheres to company policy.
- It is infrequent and minimal in duration.
- Does not interfere with work responsibilities or impact other users by consuming excessive bandwidth, storage, or system resources.

Employees are expected to exercise good judgment when using IT resources for personal reasons. This privilege may be restricted or revoked at any time at the organization's discretion

Software

To safeguard Stride-owned systems from security threats, downloading or installing software without prior authorization is strictly prohibited. This restriction applies to all software, including open-source programs, freeware, and other no-cost applications, regardless of their source or intended use. All software installations require prior approval from a designated member of IT and Information Security to ensure compatibility, security, and compliance with organizational policies. Requests can be submitted through the Artificial Intelligence (AI) Tool or New Software Request form.

Bring Your Own Device (BYOD)

Stride defines a personal device as any computer device, such as a laptop, tablet, or smartphone, that is not owned by Stride and is used for any access to Stride information and data stores. This policy also applies to personally owned routers, switches, modems, or other devices that act as a connection point from a workforce member-owned device (such as a laptop) to the internet.

To protect Stride systems, information, and data from potential risks, all personal devices accessing Stride-owned systems, resources, or applications must meet the same security requirements as Stride-owned devices. This may require workforce members to invest in additional safeguarding applications, such as antivirus software. Additionally, workforce members must follow essential security practices to maintain the integrity of their remote workspace.

- Personally owned network devices must be regularly updated with the latest firmware and software to ensure optimal security and performance.
- All personally owned devices, including network devices, must be secured with complex passwords to prevent unauthorized modification, data exposure, and access to the workforce member's network.
- Restrict physical access to devices with authorized access to Stride systems or data, including network devices, to minimize security risks.

Individual Accountability

All users are responsible for maintaining security and accountability when accessing IT resources and organizational information. It is essential to prevent unauthorized activities associated with their user ID(s) by adhering to the following best practices:

- Locking your computer screen whenever stepping away to prevent unauthorized access.

- Safeguard your user ID(s) and login credentials from misuse or unauthorized access.
- Take full responsibility for all access to Stride's information resources and technology under your user ID(s), as well as any activity originating from a system under your control.
- Recognize that your user ID and password serve as your electronic signature.
- Access only authorized or publicly available information.

Prohibited Actions

- Do not:
    - Share passwords with anyone, including IT support.
    - Access another person's system, files, or data without explicit permission.
    - Use another user's account to access information systems.

Document Retention

Employees must review and follow the Document Retention Policy (DRP) available on the Stride Policy Index. The DRP outlines retention schedules for documents and personal data, both electronic and paper-based, on legal and business requirements.

Some documents may be stored across multiple departments. In such cases, department heads will designate a primary repository and ensure duplicated copies are deleted per retention schedules. Each department is responsible for compliance with the DRP, and department heads will guide any necessary actions regarding paper documents.

Restrictions on Off-Site Transmission and Storage of Information

To safeguard Stride information, users are strictly prohibited from transmitting restricted, non-public, personal, private, proprietary, sensitive, confidential, or trade secret organizational data through personal email accounts (e.g., Gmail, Hotmail, Yahoo) or using personal email to conduct organizational business.

Additionally, restricted information—including code, project files, proprietary documents, financial data, personal information, and trade secrets—must not be stored on non-organizational devices or unapproved third-party file storage services, such as Google Drive, Google Docs, or similar repositories.

Devices containing organizational information must remain under direct supervision or be physically secured at all times. These devices must never be placed in transportation carrier luggage systems to prevent loss or unauthorized access.

Restrictions on Sharing Data with Unauthorized AI Platforms

Users are strictly prohibited from inputting, transmitting, or sharing any Stride data – including restricted, non-public, personal, private, proprietary, sensitive, confidential, or trade secret information – on unauthorized artificial intelligence platforms, applications, or services. This includes AI-powered chatbots, content generation tools, or other automated systems that have not been explicitly approved by Stride. The use of such platforms introduces significant risks related to data security, privacy, and unauthorized access, potentially exposing organizational and student/personal information to external entities.

Incident Reporting & Accountability

- If your computer is lost or stolen, report it immediately to the local police department, IT Security (Cyber@k12.com), and your direct supervisor.
- Once a police report is filed, provide a copy of the report to Human Resources and IT Security.
- A replacement computer will only be issued after the required documentation has been received and verified by Stride.
- An All Other Requests form must be completed to request a replacement device.

Damaged Computer

- Report the issue to IT Support immediately to assess whether the computer can be repaired.
- If the device is repairable, follow IT's guidance on submitting it for servicing.
- If a replacement is required, complete an All Other Requests form.
- Return the damaged device to IT for proper disposal or recycling, if applicable.

General IT Equipment Guidelines

Users must take reasonable precautions to secure IT assets. Common sense and good judgment should be applied when handling equipment in any situation, including but not limited to:

General Laptop Guidelines

- Keep your laptop in sight or securely stored when not in use to minimize the risk of loss or damage.
- Never store passwords with or inside your laptop case, as this compromises security. Opt for a password manager.
- Avoid placing food or drinks near your laptop, as spills can cause irreversible damage.

While at the Office

- Take your laptop home at night or store it in a locked, secure location when not in use.
- Always lock or log out of your laptop when stepping away from your workspace to protect sensitive data.
- Never leave laptops unattended in meeting rooms – ensure they are either securely stored or actively monitored.

While Traveling in a Personal or Rental Car

- Avoid exposing your laptop to extreme temperatures, as excessive heat or cold can cause serious damage. Whenever possible, keep it with you instead of leaving it in the vehicle.
- If you must leave your laptop in the car temporarily, store it in the trunk or another hidden space to keep it out of sight and reduce the risk of theft.
- For vehicles without a trunk or lockable compartment, choose a secure and concealed location within the car to minimize exposure and deter potential thieves.

While Staying in Hotels

- Never leave your laptop unattended in your hotel room, as it increases the risk of theft.
- Store your laptop in a secure location when not in use, such as a room safe, locked luggage, or another concealed area.
- Avoid making it obvious that you're traveling with a laptop by minimizing visible accessories, like laptop bags or charging cables.

While Traveling by Air

- Always carry your laptop as a carry-on item, unless airport security explicitly requires it to be checked.
- Review the latest Transportation Security Administration (TSA) guidelines for up-to-date travel restrictions and security protocols.
- Power off and remove battery (if applicable) before packing your laptop in checked luggage to prevent accidental damage.
- Protect your laptop in transit by securing it with soft foam or bubble wrap inside luggage.
- Use TSA-approved locks for any baggage containing IT equipment to deter tampering.
- Stay alert at security checkpoints, as theft can occur during moments of distraction or staged delays.

Security When Traveling

Before traveling outside of the United States, users must submit an Overseas Travel Request Form to ensure proper security protocols are followed.

Preparing for Secure Travel:

- Bring only essential IT assets to minimize risk and exposure.
- Ensure all security patches and software updates are applied before departure. If uncertain, contact the Corporate Help Desk for assistance.
- Enable password protection on all devices to safeguard sensitive information.
- Avoid using public Wi-Fi whenever possible. If internet access is necessary, always connect through Stride's Virtual Private Network (VPN).
- Disable automatic connections to Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, and GPS when not in use to prevent unauthorized access.

Official Use of Social Media

Stride-owned social media accounts are considered privileged accounts and are subject to strict security controls. All Stride-owned accounts must be vaulted, and access is granted only to individuals whose job roles include official social media responsibilities. These accounts are intended for official use only and must not be used for personal activity.

Any content posted on behalf of Stride must align with the organization's mission, values, and brand guidelines. Public posts should comply with privacy, security, and legal policies to prevent the disclosure of sensitive or confidential information. Employees authorized to manage social media accounts are expected to use professional judgment when engaging with the public. If a situation arises that requires escalation, it must be directed to the appropriate internal teams.

Employees responsible for Stride's social media presence must ensure that all account credentials meet information security standards, including the use of unique and complex passwords that differ from those used for other IT resources. Multi-factor authentication must be enabled where applicable, and no employee is permitted to reuse Stride social media credentials for personal accounts or non-official purposes.

Personal Use of Social Media

Stride does not prohibit employees from using social media in a personal capacity; however, staff should remain mindful of how their online activity may impact the organization's reputation. If a post could reasonably be mistaken for an official statement from Stride, employees should include a clear disclaimer indicating that the views expressed are their own and do not represent the company's position.

Employees must avoid sharing confidential or sensitive information related to Stride, including internal discussions, IT security practices, or unreleased initiatives. Additionally, privacy considerations must be respected; staff should not post names, photos, videos, or contact details of customers, colleagues or business associates without permission.

As social media posts can be easily captured, shared, and misinterpreted, workforce members are expected to use discretion in their online activity. Content shared in a personal capacity should not misrepresent Stride, its employees, or its operations.

Security Considerations

To safeguard both personal and company security, employees must not use their Stride passwords for personal social media accounts. Cyber threats, including phishing attacks, frequently target social media users, so employees should stay alert and promptly report any suspicious activity to the IT security team.

Any suspected or actual security breach involving Stride's social media accounts must be reported immediately. Employees with access to these platforms are responsible for securing their credentials and ensuring full compliance with all information security policies.

Platform-Specific Security Controls

- **Facebook/Meta**

- Adjust privacy settings to limit public visibility of sensitive information.
- Enable two-factor authentication (2FA) using an authentication app or security key.
- Turn on login alerts to notify administrators of unrecognized access attempts.
- Regularly review and revoke unnecessary third-party app permissions.
- Keep account recovery options updated.

- **Twitter/X**
  - Enable 2FA with an authentication app or security key.
  - Require additional verification for password resets to prevent unauthorized access.
  - Regularly review and remove third-party app permissions.
  - Adjust tweet visibility settings as necessary.
  - Enable security alerts for unauthorized login attempts.
- **Instagram**
  - Use a private account setting where applicable.
  - Enable 2FA and use authentication apps.
  - Restrict interactions with unknown accounts.
  - Regularly review and remove third-party app permissions.
- **LinkedIn**
  - Configure privacy settings to control who can see profile details and activity.
  - Enable 2FA to secure account access.
  - Monitor account activity for suspicious login attempts.
  - Manage data export settings to protect sensitive information.

- **Google/YouTube**
    - Conduct periodic security checkups for MFA, login activity, and app permissions.
    - Enable security alerts for suspicious activity.
    - Limit third-party app integrations and revoke unnecessary access.
- **Bluesky**
    - Enable MFA and use strong, unique passwords.
    - Adjust privacy settings to control post visibility.
    - Regularly review access permissions and remove untrusted third-party apps.
    - Enable alerts for unauthorized login attempts.

Portable Electronic Device Use in Vehicles

This policy applies to any portable electronic device ("PED") that can make or receive phone calls, send messages, access the Internet, or download and respond to emails, regardless of whether the device is company-supplied, personally owned, or reimbursed by the company.

Employees are strictly prohibited from:

1. Using a PED while driving for company-related business.
2. Using a company-supplied PED while driving any vehicle, regardless of whether it is for business purposes or personal use.

This restriction applies even when using a PED with a hands-free device and includes, but is not limited to, texting, browsing the Internet, responding to emails, downloading or uploading content, and making phone calls, in accordance with state and local regulations. Additionally, personal use of company-owned devices is discouraged. While the company acknowledges that various distractions can occur while driving, minimizing PED usage is a critical step in reducing the risk of accidents for workforce members and others. Employees should always pull over to a safe location before using a PED.

Enforcement and Violations

Failure to comply with this policy may result in disciplinary action, including loss of access privileges, formal reprimands, or other corrective measures in accordance with Stride's policies. Unauthorized use of Stride-owned social media accounts, disclosure of confidential information, or online conduct that negatively impacts the organization may lead to further administrative action.